

LISTENING

#5

1 - Listen to a conversation between a customer and a store clerk about returning purchased items. Answer questions to check your understanding of the process, the reasons for the return, and the language used during the interaction, then reflect on fair store policies.

Refunds and Returns: A Listening Activity

1 - When did the customer purchase the items she is returning?

2 - What was the reason for returning the items?

3 - Did the store refuse to process the refund? (Answer Yes or No. If yes, explain why.)

4 - What did the store request from the customer in order to process her refund?

5 - What was the customer's card type? (e.g., credit, debit, Visa, Mastercard)

6 - How did the clerk greet the customer?

7 - Define the expression: "This wasn't me." (What does the customer mean by this?)

8 - What did the clerk mean by the phrase: "If you will"?

9 - Approximately how long did it take to process the refund?

10 - Critical Thinking:

What do you think are good store policies for returning merchandise—especially electronics and clothing?

(Write 2–3 suggestions and explain why they are fair to both the store and the customer.)

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

The Return Counter

Olivia had been looking forward to her new headphones for weeks. When the package finally arrived, she tore it open with anticipation, only to discover a cracked earcup and a faint buzzing sound that spoiled the audio. Disappointed, she checked the store's website and learned about their return policy: *items could be returned within 30 days, provided they were in their original packaging.*

Armed with the receipt and the damaged product, Olivia went to the store the next morning. The return counter was crowded, filled with customers holding boxes, receipts, and bags of unwanted items. A tired-looking clerk greeted her.

"Yes, how can I help you?"

Olivia explained the situation calmly, showing the defect. The clerk inspected the headphones and typed something into the computer.

"I see. You're entitled to a refund or exchange. Would you prefer a replacement or your money back?"

Olivia hesitated. A replacement meant waiting again, but a refund would give her the freedom to buy another brand. After a moment, she decided on the refund. The clerk processed the request, handed her a slip, and told her the money would be credited within five business days.

Walking out, Olivia realized that although the process wasn't pleasant, clear policies protected her as a customer. It was a reminder that knowing one's rights could turn frustration into empowerment.

Comprehension Questions

1. What problem did Olivia encounter with her new headphones?

2. What condition did the store's return policy require for items to be eligible for return?

3. How did the store clerk respond after inspecting the defective headphones?

4. Why did Olivia choose a refund instead of an exchange?

5. What broader lesson did Olivia take away from the return experience?
